

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on experience in complex disputes, regulatory matters and client-facing legal work. At BCLP, supported international investment arbitration and real estate litigation through evidence review, drafting procedural documents, preparing hearing bundles and managing deadlines across competing matters. Advises clients at Citizens Advice on welfare, employment and housing matters, translating complex statutory requirements into clear practical guidance. Data-privacy advisory experience through Q-Legal and Adobe, including UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements. Strong legal research, drafting, document management and commercial awareness skills. Based in Berkshire; available to commute to Marlow.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules: international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis.
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%.

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law.

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, carrying partial funding toward the undergraduate degree.

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories.
- Amended substantive sections of the Claimant's memorial and conducted legal research in support of the team's arguments.
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant filing deadline — coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission.
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator.
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor.

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across multiple matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, and assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials.
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes.
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, deadline tracking and cost comparisons; maintained matter records via iManage.

- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines.

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues.
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points.
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets hard deadlines.
- Translates complex statutory and regulatory requirements into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals.

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter end-to-end, from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under qualified solicitor supervision.
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations.
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline.

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's internal legal and compliance requirements.
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements.
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk.
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures.

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic).

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; UK GDPR and EU GDPR compliance; contract review; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems.

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters.